Manager research discussion

Autonomous action with evidence

How can an authorized action produce a measurable human benefit?

Sources: Manager spec

Evidence has distinct levels

Each claim requires its own observation

Level	Meaning	Current interpretation
P0	Simulation or model/task score	Research evidence
P1	Authentic execution receipt	Action evidence
P2	Independently observed state change	Live artifact verified
P3	Authentic downstream human outcome	NOT_MEASURED
P4	Causal net improvement, costs and harms	Not established
P5	Replication across settings	Not established

Sources: Manager spec / Release record

The public artifact is verifiable

Recorded verification: 21 October 2026, 14:36 UTC

6

HTML pages matched

One public product release

16

Public browser checks passed

Software scenarios, not participants

P2 artifact only. Human outcomes remain NOT_MEASURED.

Sources: Release record / Readback CI / Pages run

Prior work informs the evaluation

Original studies suggest different design requirements

Research	What it contributes	Question for Manager
HeartSteps / JITAI	Repeated decisions and availability	Does the action reach a valid opportunity?
Megastudies	Comparable arms and follow-up	Does the change persist?
Cash-transfer experiments	Separate recipient outcomes	Who benefits after costs and spillovers?
Generative Agents	Simulated behavior and interaction	What held-out result could falsify a policy?

Sources: HeartSteps / JITAI / Milkman et al. 2021 / Haushofer & Shapiro 2016 / Park et al. 2023

A support journey needs separate endpoints

Prospective definitions for the provisional finance-navigation wedge

Endpoint	Unit	Evidence still needed
Correct official destination	Browser or participant task	State which unit was tested
Completed support step	Consented support journey	Independent observation and follow-up
Recipient gain	Original outcome measure	Valid measurement and harms
Causal net benefit	Predeclared comparison	Assignment, uncertainty and total cost

A link click cannot establish support receipt.

Sources: GOV.UK completion guidance / Provisional wedge / Manager spec

Outcomes retain their original units

A measurement choice needs a version and a population

Construct	Unit and direction	Limit
Loneliness	Three-item score 3–9, higher worse	No universal diagnostic threshold
Mental wellbeing	WHO-5 0–25 or 0–100, higher better	Two-week recall and rights review
Functioning	WHODAS method-specific score	Version, scoring and license matter
Financial wellbeing	CFPB converted score	Age/mode conversion, local validity

Sources: ONS loneliness guidance / WHO-5 2024 / WHO WHODAS 2.0 / CFPB scorecard

The demo chooses NO_ACTION

An actual public readback with a deterministic decision

Observed state	Decision	Scope of the evidence
6 public pages match	NO_ACTION	An identical publication adds no new artifact
0 external writes	Keep the existing release	No new field intervention
Human outcome unknown	NOT_MEASURED	No beneficiary or causal-effect claim

The demo records a real observation and a bounded software decision.

Sources: Captured decision JSON / Demo video / Public prototype

The next study must answer a concrete question

Product question

Do people and operators identify navigation as a meaningful barrier?

The five consented interviews remain outstanding.

Scientific question

Does improving that journey cause a useful support step at acceptable cost?

A partner, protocol and independent outcome data remain outstanding.

Current contribution: inspectable artifacts and a falsifiable evaluation design.

Sources: Provisional wedge / Measurement map / Manager spec